Level 9 → Level 10: Extracting Readable Strings

Objective: Find the password within a file containing non-text data.

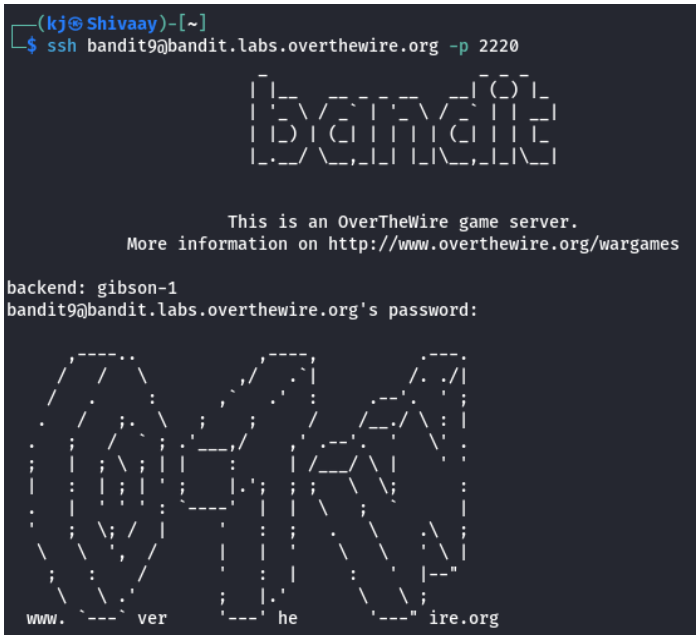
Command used:
strings data.txt | grep "="

Procedure:

1. Logged in using the bandit9 account.
2. Examined the data.txt file.
3. Used strings to extract readable character sequences from the file.
4. Piped the output to grep to locate lines containing the equals sign.
5. Inspected the matching output to identify the password.

Result: Extracted readable information from the file and located the password for the next level.

Concept learned: The strings utility is useful for examining binary or mixed-format files because it extracts sequences of printable characters. Combining it with grep narrows the output to relevant results.




```
bandit9@bandit:~$ ls
data.txt
bandit9@bandit:~$ cat data.txt | strings -e s | grep ==
========== the
[==p+
========== password
Y========== is
==========
bandit9@bandit:~$
```